

Nevertheless, the customers' men manage to come to the same tragic conclusions as the partners.

The statisticians are housed way down the hall in scholarly quiet. No noisy tickers or loquacious customers are allowed to intrude, and the Thinkers are surrounded by tomes of reference and the latest news flashes from everywhere. They all carry slide rules, which as everyone knows are more scientific than divining rods. They make exhaustive studies of many a "special situation" and eventually get to know absolutely everything about the affairs of a certain corporation, except perhaps one detail, which is that shortly after the inception of the ensuing fiscal year the corporation is going into 77b.

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*The type of customer who habitually sits in a board room is frequently just a gent who loves to chat in masculine company but who doesn't belong to a club.*

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Secluded as they are, the statisticians, too, manage to come to the same general conclusions as do the partners and the customers' men. If these conclusions can be generalized, the underlying principle may be loosely stated thus: Buy them when they are up and sell them when the margin clerk insists that you do so.

It is obviously impossible for the thinking Wall Streeter to avoid acting on that principle.

He certainly can't buy them when they are down, because when they are down "conditions" are terrible. You can't ask an experienced Wall Street man to buy stocks when car loadings have just hit a new low and unemployment is at a peak and steel capacity is less than half of normal and a very big man ("of course I can't tell you his name") has just informed him in confidence that one of the big underwriting houses in the Middle West is in really serious trouble.